

CHUTNEYS · ANDHRA

Palak *Ulikaram*

Spinach cooked down with a tangy, garlicky Andhra masala — roasted chilies and coriander ground with tamarind and a whole lot of garlic, then simmered into the greens until the oil comes shining back to the top. Eat it with hot white rice and a spoon of ghee, and don't count the garlic cloves.

from the kitchen of Noor

PALAK ULIKARAM



main photo — the finished dish ♦

dark, glossy, and ready for rice



side photo ♦

the ground masala



side photo ♦

spinach going in

Palak *Ulikaram*

from the kitchen of Noor

A BIG BOWL FOR THE FAMILY • A TANGY AFTERNOON DISH

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

FOR THE GROUND MASALA

- 1 big onion, roughly chopped
- a fistful of garlic cloves
- a lime-sized ball of tamarind
- a good handful of dried red chilies
- 2–3 spoons coriander seeds (dhania)
- a spoon of cumin (zira)
- salt, to taste

FOR THE TEMPERING & GREENS

- oil, a generous pour
- mustard seeds & cumin (zira)
- chana dal & urad dal, a spoon each
- a sprig of curry leaves
- a pinch of asafoetida (hing)
- red chili powder, to your bravery
- turmeric (haldi), a good pinch
- lots & lots of spinach, chopped
- coriander leaves, to finish
- ghee, for serving

Amounts are by feel — start with more garlic and chili than seems wise, then taste as you go.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Roast the whole spices.** Lightly dry-sauté the dried red chilies, coriander seeds and cumin until warm and toasty — don't burn them.
- 2 Grind.** Blend the onion, garlic, tamarind, salt and the roasted spices to a coarse paste.
- 3 Temper.** Heat oil; add mustard seeds, cumin, chana dal, urad dal and curry leaves. Let it splutter and the dals turn golden; add a pinch of hing.
- 4 Fry the paste.** Add the ground masala and fry a few minutes until it darkens and the oil separates.
- 5 Spice it.** Add chili powder, turmeric and a little more salt if needed.
- 6 Cook the spinach.** Add lots of chopped spinach. Cook and cook until the water is gone and the oil separates again.
- 7 Finish.** Stir through coriander leaves. Serve with hot rice and ghee.

Amma's note: the whole secret is patience at the end — keep cooking until the oil comes back. And add more garlic than you think.

MORE FROM THIS DISH



side photo ✦

roasting the chilies



side photo ✦

the coarse paste



side photo ✦

oil separating



side photo ✦

plated with rice